

`squid-2.5.STABLE5.tar.gz`. This uncompresses the file and creates a directory (`squid-2.5.STABLE5`) in the current working directory.

Uncompressed. What's next?

Enter the '`squid-2.5.STABLE5`' directory using the `cd squid-2.5.STABLE5` command. Here, you need to '`./configure`' your installation. You can type '`./configure --help`' to see the available options. If you're a little unsure about what you're doing, we recommend you use the default setting and just type '`./configure`' and press **[Enter]**. This sets up the default installation. As another option, you can use the '`./configure --prefix=<path>`' command, where '`<path>`' is the path to install Squid to.

This done, run '`make`' to compile Squid. Next, run the '`make install`' command. If you didn't set any parameters when running '`./configure`', Squid is installed into the default directory—`/usr/local/squid`. If you specified the '`--prefix=<path>`' switch, you'll find Squid installed to the path you specified. You now need to edit the `squid.conf` file according to your preferences, before you can think of starting the service.

Huh? Conf, what?

Yes, conf file! Short for configuration file, it tells Squid how to run and what you want it to do. Open it using any text editor, and don't be intimidated by its length—you don't have to edit each and every line!

Within the conf file, you'll find each setting explained in detail, with the different options and examples, so you aren't going to run into too many problems.

Below, we also specify a few important lines that need editing as per your network and requirements. We suggest that those not well versed with Linux change only the following lines, as doing so will load perfectly acceptable default values for Squid.

Under the 'Network Options' header, the first line specifies the port on which Squid listens to incoming connections. The default value is 3128. In case this port is already in use or is inconvenient, uncomment the line, i.e., remove the '#' in front of the line that reads '# http_port 3128', and change '3128' to any unused and acceptable port. This can be anything above port 1024, as most ports below that are used by root processes, and could cause conflicts; the default is always recommended though.

Next, we move on to the 'Objects which affect the cache size' header. Here, you can specify the minimum and maximum size of objects that the proxy caches. This determines the Internet surfing experience that you or the proxy users will have. An extremely high setting here eats up hard disk space and the other extreme wastes bandwidth. Depending on your Internet connection speed, you need to decide whether to change this or leave the default values. For most connections, the defaults are fine.

The first setting, '`cache_mem`' sets apart 8 MB of RAM on the Squid system for quick caches. This is fine for, say, 2 to 10 users. However, this may not be enough for a proxy server in a large company. In this case, if you have a decent amount of RAM on the server, set this higher to, say, 64 MB. However, don't reduce it, as performance will decrease. Note that this is just the amount of mem-

```
acl manager proto cache_object
acl localhost src 127.0.0.1/255.255.255.255
acl to_localhost dst 127.0.0.0/8
acl SSL_ports port 443 563
acl Safe_ports port 80          # http
acl Safe_ports port 21         # ftp
acl Safe_ports port 443 563    # https, s
acl Safe_ports port 70         # gopher
acl Safe_ports port 210        # wais
acl Safe_ports port 1025-65535 # unregist
acl Safe_ports port 280        # http-mg
acl Safe_ports port 488        # gss-http
acl Safe_ports port 591        # filemake
acl Safe_ports port 777        # multilin
acl CONNECT method CONNECT
acl our_networks src 128.128.6.54
http_access allow manager localhost
http_access deny manager
# Deny requests to unknown ports
http_access deny !Safe_ports
# Deny CONNECT to other than SSL ports
http_access deny CONNECT !SSL_ports
#
# We strongly recommend to uncomment the
# web applications running on the proxy s
# one who can access services on "localho
http_access deny to_localhost
#
# INSERT YOUR OWN RULE(S) HERE TO ALLOW A
#
# Example rule allowing access from your
# to list your (internal) IP networks fro
# be allowed
http_access allow our_networks
#
# And finally deny all other access to th
http_access deny all
```

When editing the `squid.conf` file, be very careful about the acl lines you add. Make sure that all acl lines and 'http_access allow' lines appear before the 'http_access deny all line', otherwise you're going to have a proxy that won't allow anyone to connect

ory Squid uses as cache, and not the total amount of memory used. If you have 256 MB of RAM on the server, setting `cache_mem` to, say, 128 MB could cause unpleasant crashes. We suggest you set this to 64 MB for a server with 256 MB of RAM and a maximum of 128 MB for servers with 512 MB of RAM or greater.

Squid gives top priority to all currently downloading objects (also called in-transit objects). Therefore, if you have a large amount of traffic coming in through Squid, and a low `cache_mem` setting, everything will be cached to the hard drive, which is slower, and also means non-stop writing to the disk; reducing the hard drive's life.

Only uncomment the `cache_mem 8 MB` line if you want to increase this value.

Keep an eye out for the **Tag: acl** header, which lets you set IP addresses of systems using Squid as the proxy. If you have a small number of users, you can set an acl line for each one. However, if you

Setting up the Clients

Do the following to set your client browsers to use the proxy server:

Mozilla

Go to **Edit > Preferences**, and expand the 'Advanced' option on the left. Click on 'Proxies' and click on the Manual proxy configuration button. Enter the IP address of your server under 'HTTP Proxy' and the port you set Squid to listen to incoming requests on. Click OK and try opening a Web site.

Internet Explorer

Navigate to **Tools > Internet Options**, and click on the Connections tab. Click the 'LAN Settings' button and check the Proxy

Server checkbox. Add the local IP address of the machine that runs Squid, and its listening port. Click OK twice to exit the configuration menu and you're done.

Opera

Go to **Tools > Preferences**, click on the Network option in the left pane, and then on the 'Proxy Servers' button. Put a tick in the HTTP checkbox, add the local IP of the Squid system and the port that you set. If Squid runs as a proxy for the FTP and HTTPS protocols as well, tick the respective checkboxes and add the same details. Click OK, then Apply, and then OK again.